

The Mercor Application Companion Guide

Your blueprint to bypassing the waitlist and passing the AI gatekeepers.

1. The ATS Resume Checklist

Before you upload your resume to the Mercor portal, make sure you have checked off every item on this list. The AI evaluates your resume based on structure and keywords.

- [] **Standard Formatting:** Use a single-column layout (no tables or weird sidebars).
 - [] **No Graphics:** Remove all images, charts, and icons.
 - [] **Standard Fonts:** Use Arial, Times New Roman, or Calibri.
 - [] **Clear Section Headers:** Use standard names like "Experience", "Education", and "Skills".
 - [] **Bullet Points:** Use standard bullet points (dots), not custom icons.
 - [] **Action Verbs:** Start *every single* bullet point with a strong action verb (e.g., *Architected, Developed, Led, Engineered*).
 - [] **Quantified Impact:** Ensure at least 60% of your bullet points contain a number, percentage, or dollar amount (e.g., *Increased revenue by 15%, Led a team of 4*).
 - [] **Keyword Density:** Mention your core skills (e.g., Python, React, NLP) organically 2-3 times across different roles.
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2. The AI Video Interview Framework

The one-way video interview is where 80% of applicants fail. You are not talking to a human; you are talking to an AI that is transcribing your words and running sentiment analysis.

The STAR+ Method

Structure every answer using this framework:

1. **Situation:** Briefly set the context (10 seconds).
2. **Task:** What was the specific problem you needed to solve? (10 seconds)
3. **Action:** What exactly did *you* do? Focus on your individual contribution, not the team's. Use active language. (30 seconds)
4. **Result:** What was the quantifiable outcome? (10 seconds)
5. **+ Plus:** What did you learn that applies to this new role? (10 seconds)

Pro Tips for the AI Interview:

- **Pacing:** Speak clearly and at a moderate pace. Do not rush. The AI needs to transcribe your words accurately.
 - **Micro-expressions:** Maintain eye contact with the camera and smile. Some AI systems analyze facial expressions for confidence markers.
 - **Audio Quality:** Use a dedicated microphone if possible. Muffled audio leads to poor transcription and a lower score.
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3. High-Impact Action Verbs

Replace weak verbs (helped, worked on, responsible for) with these high-impact alternatives:

Leadership: Orchestrated, Directed, Spearheaded, Championed

Technical: Architected, Engineered, Deployed, Optimized

Results: Accelerated, Maximized, Streamlined, Surpassed

Communication: Negotiated, Persuaded, Clarified, Synthesized

Keep this guide open on your phone while you navigate the application process. Good luck!